

Inventory Search: AH, CR, PM

Author cestreitman@ Updated 05/20/2026 UX email@ ENG email@

0.1

The Problem

Users struggle finding items in their inventory outside of their hoard

- ◆ The Crossroads, Auction House, and Private Message platforms all require the user to search by scrolling through their inventory to find the item they want to trade
- ◆ Unlike the Hoard, the CR, AH, and PM do not have a search function, nor a filter function beyond item type, nor do they have pages to split their inventory into digestible chunks to parse through

Context: this is a hypothetical PRD based on research I performed in [this report](#). I have no inside knowledge of Flight Rising's codebase.

0.2

Target use cases

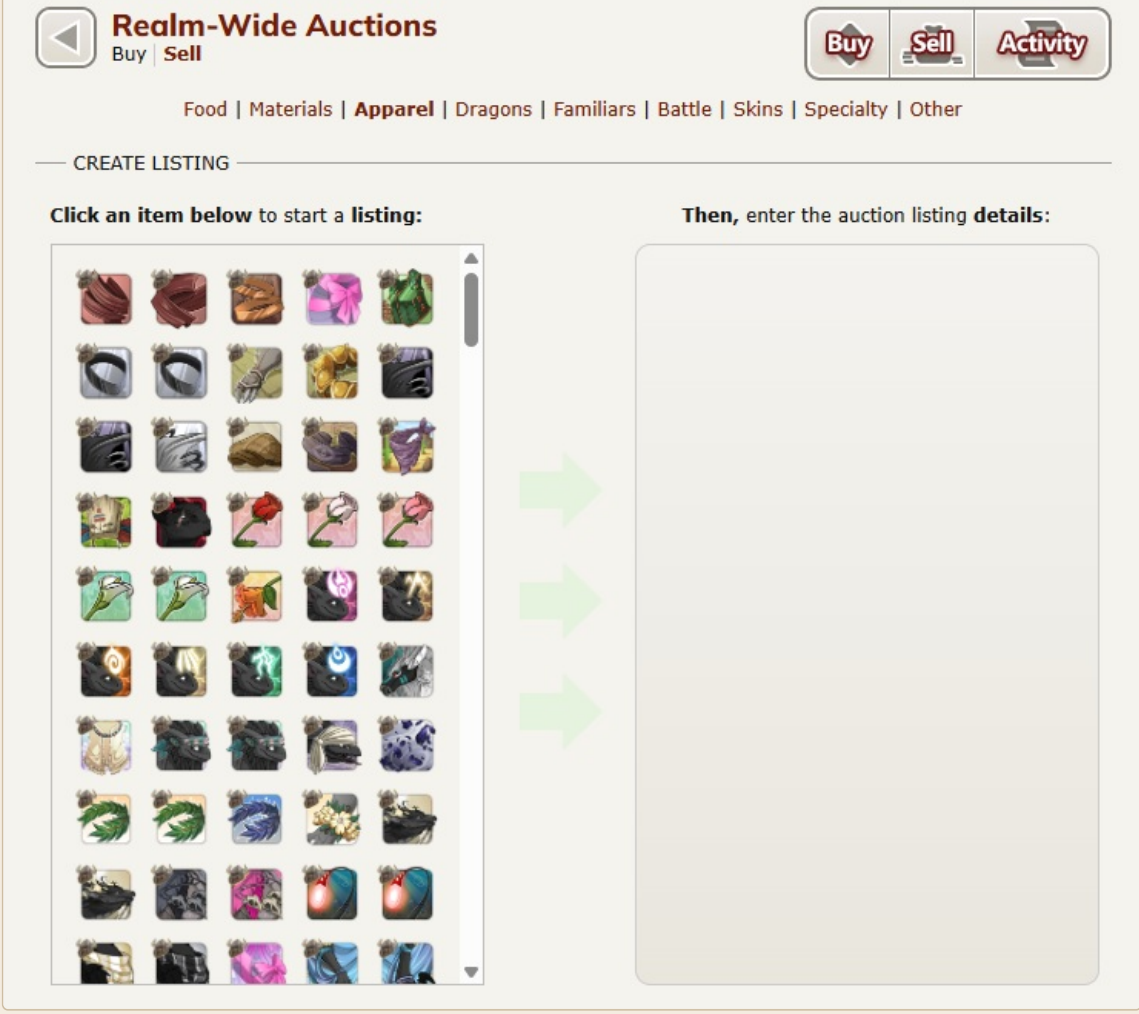
We are trying to ease use for all users with large inventories who sell and trade goods:

1. As a Crossroads user with 28 pages worth of food, I would like to find and sell a stack of puckerberries easily
2. As an Auction House user who has 500 total dragons and 300 fodder dragons during a battle, I want to sell my fodder dragons quickly at peak times. To sell them quickly, I must find them quickly
3. As a Private Message user gifting a friend a specific apparel, I want to find that apparel item without scrolling through hundreds of unrelated items

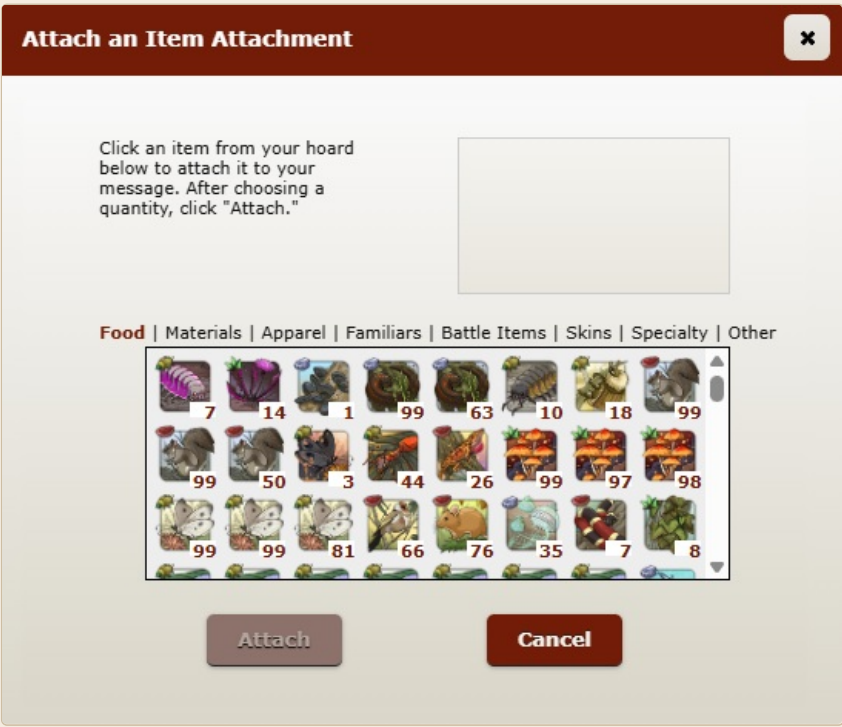
0.3

Current user journeys

1. User initiates listing/trade on AH, CR, or PM.
2. User lands on the inventory popup, which displays items grouped by category (Food, Materials, Apparel, etc.).
3. User selects the relevant category tab.
4. User scrolls through the category's inventory grid—which has no pagination, search, or filtering—to locate the desired item.
5. User clicks the item, inputs quantity and (on AH) price, and submits.



Current state — the Auction House create-listing inventory popup: category tabs, but no search, filter, or pagination.



Current state — the Private Message "Attach an Item" popup has the same scroll-only browse model.

0.4

Proposed Solution

Add a **legacy-compatible search input** (modeled after the previous Customize tab search) to the AH, CR, and PM inventory views. This scopes the feature to existing UI patterns, keeping eng cost low and avoiding dependencies on the broader site-wide UI modernization currently underway. The advanced search-and-filter pane available in the Hoard is deferred until those surfaces receive modernization.

Goals

- ◆ Reduce time spent parsing through inventories
- ◆ Help users conduct trades more easily and quickly

Non-Goals

- ◆ Modernizing the UI of the Auction House, Crossroads, or Private Messages
- ◆ Improving the search mechanism as it exists in the Hoard (only seek to implement it elsewhere)

0.5

Measurable Outcomes

- ◆ **Adoption:** >40% of AH/CR/PM sessions involving the inventory popup use the search bar within 30 days post-launch.
- ◆ **Efficiency (primary):** Median time from inventory-popup open to item click decreases by >20% among users with >200 inventory items, measured 30 days post-launch.
- ◆ **Peak-window lift:** Total AH/CR/PM listings created during high-velocity windows (2 hours post-battle-flip, NotN final 12 hours, festival final 12 hours) increase >15% post-launch.
- ◆ **Economy health (secondary):** Week-over-week AH listing volume increases >10% in the 60 days post-launch, indicating reduced trade friction is unlocking suppressed supply.
- ◆ **Qualitative signal:** Sentiment in Flight Rising Discussion forum threads referencing AH/CR/PM trading workflows post-launch, tracked against a pre-launch baseline of complaints about inventory friction in the prior 12 months.

0.6

Instrumentation Requirements

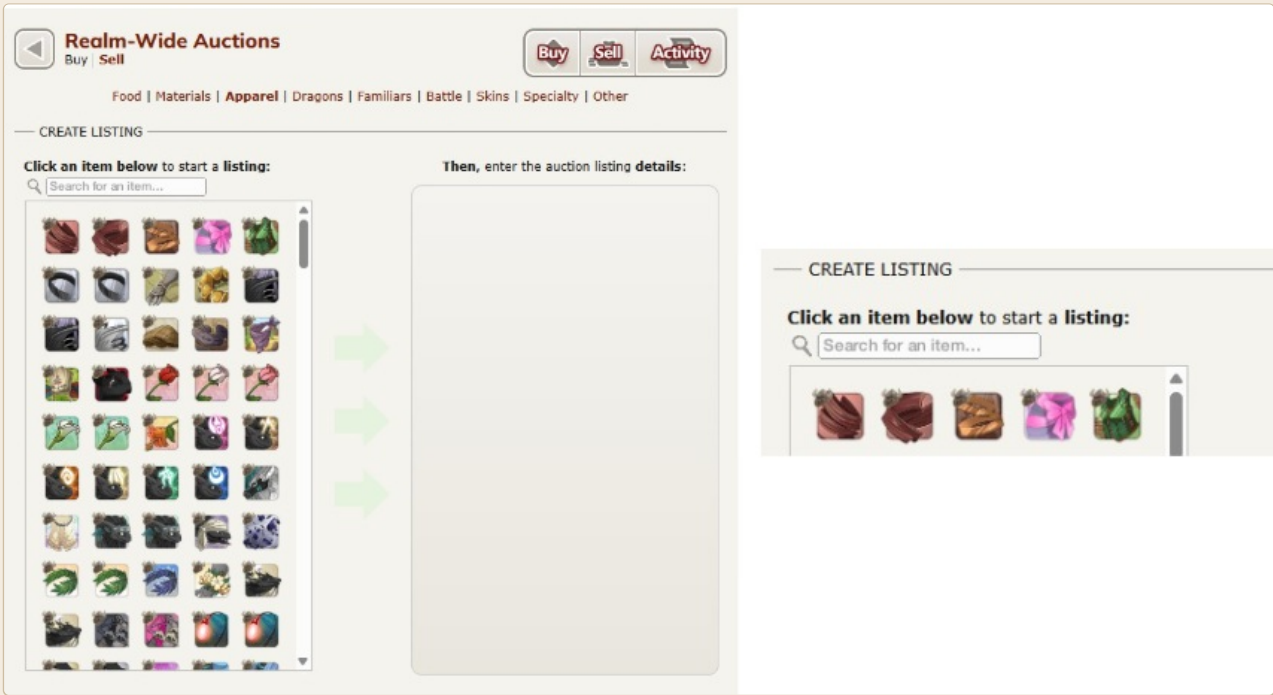
Several proposed metrics require new event tracking not currently available:

- ◆ **Search bar interactions** (queries entered, results clicked, time-to-click): new client-side events; minimal eng cost given the feature is already being built.
- ◆ **Inventory popup session timing** (open – action – close): requires a session model linking discrete events; medium eng cost, but reusable for future analytics on CR/AH/PM flows.

0.7

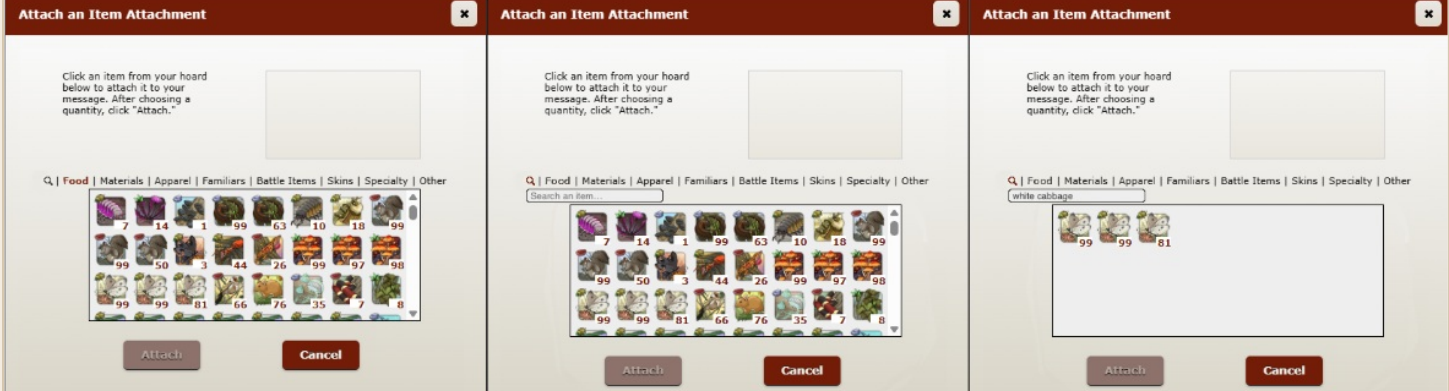
Requirements

- ◆ **P0** User can search their inventory by item name within the AH listing-creation flow
 - Search applies within the currently selected category tab (Food, Materials, etc.), matching existing user mental model from the Hoard.



Proposed — a single search input added above the AH create-listing grid (detail at right).

- ◆ **P0** User can search their inventory by item name within the CR trade-creation flow.
- ◆ **P0** User can search their inventory by item name within the PM item-attachment flow.



Proposed — the PM item-attachment flow: default, focused, and matched ("white cabbage") states.



- ◆ **P0** Search uses fuzzy/partial matching rather than exact match. This imports the same system as the partial matching on the buy-side of the AH search to maintain consistency with users' established mental models from elsewhere on the site, e.g.

Query	Matches
"Spar"	"Spare Inventory Crate", "Sparksylph Husk", "Sparkling Stinger Crate"
"Spar " (intentional space)	"Spare Inventory Crate", "Sparksylph Husk", "Sparkling Stinger Crate"
"Spar i"	(no matches; space treated literally)
"Spare"	"Spare Inventory Crate"
"Inventory"	"Spare Inventory Crate" (substring match)

- ◆ **P1** Search is dismissible; user can close the search affordance and return to the default browse view without losing their place
- ◆ **P2** Filter options (Color, Rarity, Subcategory) as available in the Hoard, Customize tab, Dressing Room
 - Scoped out of P0; revisit if the surface receives a UI modernization pass. See appendix.

0.8

Risks & Open Questions

- ◆ **Code base reuse vs reimplementation:** Is the Customize tab's legacy search code still in the codebase? If yes, eng can lift-and-shift, which is cheap. If it was removed during a refactor, eng has to reimplement from scratch, which means scope expands. Open question; recommend a feasibility check by eng to resolve
- ◆ **Performance on transaction surfaces:** AH/CR/PM listing flows mutate inventory state in-session as users build trades. Search must update reactively to inventory changes within the session; confirm with eng whether existing search logic handles this.
- ◆ **Mobile behavior:** Existing AH/CR/PM inventory views work on mobile; adding a text input changes touch targets and may trigger virtual keyboard behavior that obscures the inventory grid. Recommend explicit mobile QA pass before launch.

0.9

Rollout Plan

FR's rollout model bundles non-bug-fix features into Announcement Posts rather than shipping them independently. This means small QOL features like this one need to ride along with other improvements to justify their inclusion. Two options:

- ◆ **Bundle with the next scheduled product release.** Roll the search feature out alongside the next planned Announcement Post, listed in the bottom section. Lowest schedule risk; ties shipping cadence to existing roadmap. (recommended)
- ◆ **Bundle a QOL release.** Wait for more features to be created (e.g. the F-keybind and festival item unretirement features from this roadmap) and roll them out all wrapped together as a dedicated "quality of life" announcement.

1.0

Appendix

Glossary

- ◆ **Hoard:** Main inventory storage surface; the only full-inventory view that currently supports search and filtering
- ◆ **Auction House (AH):** Player-driven marketplace for site-wide item and dragon listings.
- ◆ **Crossroads (CR):** Direct player-to-player trade interface; supports negotiated item-for-item or item-for-currency exchanges.
- ◆ **Private Message (PM):** Player-to-player messaging system; supports attaching items to messages for casual trades or gifts.
- ◆ **Customize tab:** Dragon appearance editor; previously included a simpler legacy search referenced as the model for this PRD's P0.
- ◆ **Dressing Room:** Apparel preview tool; currently uses the modern search-and-filter pane similar to the Hoard, but only for apparel
- ◆ **Coliseum:** Turn-based combat surface used for resource farming.
- ◆ **Battle flip:** When two flights (clans, every user is in one) battle, they fight for first on the game's "Dominance Leaderboard". A flip is when the second-place flight overtakes their enemy flight for first place on the leaderboard, inciting a flurry of fodder dragons bought and exalted by the New #2 flight to retake their spot as #1.
- ◆ **NotN (Night of the Nocturne):** Time-limited annual event with exclusive items and dragons; final hours drive peak trading activity as users scramble to acquire or offload dangerous goods.
- ◆ **Fodder dragons:** Low-value dragons bred or hatched specifically to be used as combat resources or sold in bulk; large quantities accumulate quickly in active players' inventories, especially before or during battles.

UI implementation note

1. **Legacy-compatible (recommended P0):** Add a single search input above the existing category tabs on each surface, styled to match the surface's current UI. No layout changes to the inventory grid itself. Lowest eng cost; preserves existing user flows.
2. **Hoard-parity:** Port the full Hoard search-and-filter pane to AH/CR/PM, including Sort, Stack Size, Color, Rarity, and other filter dropdowns. Higher eng cost; introduces UI inconsistency with the rest of the AH/CR/PM surfaces unless those receive concurrent modernization.